

COMPREHENSION: *Read each passage carefully and answer the questions that follow it*

PASSAGE I

One of the interesting things to me about spaceship is that it is a mechanical vehicle, just as an automobile. If you own a car, you realize that you must put oil and gas into it, and you must put water in the radiator and take care of the car as a whole.

You begin to develop quite a little thermodynamic sense. You know that you are either going to have to keep the machine in a good order or it is going to be in trouble and fail to function.

We have not been seeing our Spaceship Earth as an integrally designed machine which to be persistently successful, must be comprehended and serviced in total.

Now there is one outstanding important fact regarding Spaceship Earth, and this is that no instruction book came with it. I think it is very significant that there is no instruction book, for successfully operating of our ship, in view of the infinite attention to all other details displayed by our ship.

It must be taken as deliberate and purposeful that an instruction book was omitted. Lack of instruction has forced us to find out that there are two kinds of mangoes – unripe mangoes that will kill us and ripe mangoes which will nourish us.

And we had to find out ways of telling which-was-which mangoes before we ate it or otherwise we would die. So we were forced, because of this to devise scientific experimental procedures and to interpret effectively the significance of the experimental

findings. Thus, because the instruction manual was missing, we are learning how we can safely survive on the planet.

Quite clearly, all living being are utterly helpless at the moment of birth. The human child stays helpless longer than the young of any species.

Apparently, it is part of 'invention' that man is meant to be utterly helpless through certain anthropological phases. When he begins to be able to get on a little better, he is meant to discover some of the physical principles inherent in the universe as well as the many recourses around him which will further multiply his knowledge.

Designed into this Spaceship Earth's total wealth was a big safety factor. This allowed man to be very ignorant for a long time until he had amassed enough experiences from which to extract

progressively the system of generalized principles governing increase of energy. The design omission of the instruction book forced man to discover retrospectively just what his most important capabilities are.

He learned to generalize fundamental principles of universe.

Adapted from Oluikpe, B.O. et al (2005) Intensive English for Senior Secondary School 2, Onitsha: AFP

1. Which Use of English Paper Type is given to you?

- A. Type A
- B. Type B
- C. Type C
- D. Type D

2. According to the writer, the exciting thing about Spaceship Earth is that

- A. has no instruction manual

- B. it is not difficult to maintain
- C. is peculiar to other automobiles
- D. is relatively easy to operate

3. The absence of instruction manual in Spaceship Earth has

- A. made the operation of the Spaceship Earth difficult
- B. forced man to devise other means of travelling in spacecraft
- C. challenged man's inquisitiveness
- D. made man helpless

4. From the passage, it can be deduced that man

- A. learns by experiment and education
- B. learns by chance and accidentally
- C. is incapable of solving all his problems
- D. by his nature is in constant search of knowledge

5. The writer's mood in the passage is that of

- A. non-committal
- B. pessimism
- C. optimism
- D. frustration

PASSAGE II

Stress is by far the most common cause of ill health in our society, and may be the underlying cause of as many as 70-80% of all visits to family doctors. It is also the problem that every doctor shares with patients.

Experts note that stress is an issue everyone can relate to experimentally. In studying and better understanding about stress, we can derive personal as well as professional benefits.

Stress can be overcome without undergoing duress. They often say anyone who wants to help someone deal with his/her stress should learn to handle his/hers first. The manifestations of stress are legion. It can contribute or

mimic just about any symptom you can think of. However, the main symptoms are physical, mental, emotional and behavioural.

The causes of stress are multiple and varied but they can be classified into external and internal. External stressors can include relatively getting sick or dying, jobs being lost or people criticising or one becoming angry. However, most of the stress people experience is self-generated.

Experts tell us that we create the majority of our upset indicating that because we cause most of our own stress, we can do something about it. This gives us a measure of choice and control that we do not always have when outside forces act on us. This also leads to a basic premise about stress reduction.

To master stress-change, you have to figure out what you are doing that is contributing to your problem and change it. These changes fall into behaviour, thinking, lifestyle choices and / or situations you are in. By getting to the root cause of your stress, you can prevent recurrences.

As a way of draining off stress energy, nothing beats aerobic exercise. To understand why, we need to review what stress is. People often think of stress as pressure at work, a demanding boss, a sick child or rush-hour traffic.

These may be triggers but stress is actually the body reaction to factors such as these. Stress is the fight-or-flight response in the body, mediated by adrenaline and other stress hormones, and comprised of such physiologic changes as increased heart rate and blood pressure, faster breathing, muscle tension, dilated

pupils, dry mouth and increased blood sugar. In other words, stress is the state of increased arousal necessary for an organism to defend itself at a time of danger.

Exercise is the most logical way to dissipate the excess energy. It is what our bodies are trying to do when we pace around or tap our legs and fingers. It is much better to channel it into a more complete form of exercise like a brisk walk, a run, a bike ride, or a game of squash.

Just as we are all capable of mounting up and sustaining a stress reaction, we have also inherited the ability to put our bodies into a state of deep relaxation called the 'relaxation response'.

In this state, all the physiologic events in the stress reaction are reversed. Pulse slows, blood pressure falls, breathing slows and muscle relax.

**Adopted from VANGUARD,
19TH March, 2008**

6. The expression, ... stress is an issue everybody can relate to experimentally, means that

- A. it is better understood when experienced
- B. its problem can be solved by everybody
- C. everybody avoids it
- D. everybody encounters it.

7. Which of the following is true according to the passage?

- A. Stress is mostly caused by internal factors
- B. Stress can only be avoided during relaxation
- C. Stress is better handled by the individual
- D. The issues of stress can be solved with no effort

8. According to the passage, the major step in controlling stress is

- A. changing one's attitude to stressors
- B. understanding the history of disease
- C. visiting family doctors for check-up and treatment
- D. constant exercise to dissipate every energy

9. The experts feel one can control one's stress because

- A. its causes are understandable
- B. it is not difficult to control
- C. external factors contribute less stress
- D. it is individually initiated

10. From the passage, it can be deduced that stress is

- A. hormonal disorder in the body system
- B. individually induced problems
- C. bodily reaction to internal factors
- D. bodily reaction to external factors

PASSAGE III

There are many indicators with which to assess or measure corruption. One of them is the affluent living habit of the public official compared to his / her income.

Corruption occurs when a public official expects to be induced to perform an act which that public officials is ordinarily required to do by law.

Corruption can slow down development. One of the most widely discussed consequences of corruption is the distortion of governmental expenditure. This often results in public money being wasted on white elephant projects, rather than people oriented services, such as health and education.

As a result, more opportunities are presented for corrupt use or diversion of funds. Raising the

ethical standard of governance can lead to many benefits especially for the economic, political and social development of a country.

Fighting corruption and promoting governance is therefore crucial to developing an environment that facilitates the social, political and economic development of the people.

However, while there are often general statement made about the effect of corruption on poverty and development. There is not an explicit recognition that corruption is more than just wealth misappropriation or abuse of power.

Corruption impoverishes countries and deprives their citizens of good governance. It destabilizes economic systems. When crime and other illegal activities flourish, basic public functions are eroded and the quality of life of the

people is reduced. Bribery, for example, is universally regarded as a crime, but it also reflects socio-economic problems that require broad-based preventive measures, and the involvement of the society at large.

Another implication of global measures against corruption in making government work better by improving the economy.

Finally, redesigning political and regulatory structures will reduce corruption and other anti-system players that encourage corrupt practice.

11. According to the writer, corruption is triggered off by

- A. unnecessary affluence
- B. selfish interest
- C. private officials
- D. public officers

12. From the passage, one of the consequences of corruption is that

- A. large projects are executed
- B. it is beneficial to wealth people whole stole public wealth
- C. it impedes the progress of a nation
- D. people get what they want with so much money to spend

13. Who, according to the writer should prevent corruption?

- A. Lawyers and Police
- B. Corrupt public officers
- C. The government
- D. The people

14. Which of the following is an indication of ethical standard of governance?

- A. Fundamental human right
- B. Socio-economic instability
- C. Democratic governance
- D. Bloated expenditure

15. The essence of fighting corruption, according to the passage, is to

- A. send the corrupt to yell
- B. promote good governance
- C. punish corrupt politicians
- D. make people richer

PASSAGE IV

The passage below has gaps numbered 16 to 25.

Immediately following each gap, four options are provided. Choose the most appropriate option for each gap.

Each question carries 2 marks

Drought is a word that invokes strong emotions. This is not surprising as the ... 16 ... [A. ideology B. phenomenon C. idea D. component] is usually accompanied by a number of unpleasant developments. These developments have ... 17 ... [A. feedback B. Results C. Implications D. outcomes] for all citizens, starting from the peasant farmers to the state and federal

governments which may be plunged into emergency and crises situations which, if not successfully ...18... [A. managed B. examined D. studied] could result in social unrest.

The timeliness of the onset of the rains in various regions of the country and their adequate distribution thereafter have become ...19... [A. objects B. subjects C. issues D. topics] of considerable anxiety to all people.

The fact, however, is that periodic reduction in normal ...20... [A. amount B. supply C. size D. flood] of rainfall in the country is not new.

Since large areas of the country are drought prone, the consequences are ...21... [A. effective B. disastrous C. evident D. inevitable]. Dry spells could be very severe. There are two aspects of coping with drought.

One has to do with emergency measures and the other with ...22... [A. routine B. organized C. urgent D. delayed] measures. An immediate consequence of any drought would be famine.

In addition, where whole populations are forced to abandon their lands or pastures in search of food, there are bound to be other lasting and ...23... [A. longitudinal B. objective C. simultaneous D. parallel] consequences such as distress, sales of cattle by livestock owners in order to buy food.

Government should provide farmers with agricultural inputs and ensure that they have easy access to these inputs under the relief ...24... [A. action B. process C. scheme D. plan].

Emergency measures will be much more ...25... [A. normal B. correct C. idealistic D. effective] if a mechanism is established to

ensure adequate preparedness and defence against the occurrence of drought.

Adapted from Oluikpe, B.O.A. et al (2005) Intensive English for Senior Secondary School, Onitsha: Lexis, Structure and Oral Forms

In each of questions 26 to 35, select the option that best explains the information conveyed in the sentence.

Each question carries 2 marks.

26. Though Mr. Iro is a new chairman, he views other members with jaundiced eye.

- A. He takes a rather forceful position on dealing with his members
- B. He takes an unfavourable position concerning his members
- C. He takes a sickly view of his members

D. He takes a rather hazy view of his members

27. People are not interested in who rules.

- A. People are not ruled by the leaders they want
- B. People are not concerned about who rules them
- C. The rulers are not concerned about the people
- D. People who rule are not interested in the ruled

28. It was good to steer a middle course in whatever one does.

- A. It is always good to get midway in anything one does
- B. It is always good to act with moderation
- C. It is always good to move away from the forefront
- D. It is always good to work very hard.

29. The witness said he had no axe to grind with his brothers

- A. He had no hatred for the brothers
- B. He had no axe and therefore stole the matchet
- C. He had no axe and therefore borrowed their matchet
- D. He had no vested interest in the brothers

30. The footballers moved with their tails between their legs.

- A. they moved happily because they won the match
- B. they were unhappy because they had been despised by their opponents
- C. they were ashamed because they had been defeated
- D. they moved with their tails between their legs.

31. The headmaster managed to talk his way out of having to give a speech

- A. he delivered a speech despite the difficulty

- B. he managed to give a speech out of a difficult situation
- C. he managed to get himself out of a difficult situation
- D. he managed to talk on his way.

32. As regards the matter, we have crossed the rubicon

- A. we are completely at a loss
- B. we are irrevocably committed
- C. we are already qualified
- D. we are perfectly committed

33. Uche is full of himself

- A. He is conceited
- B. He is complete
- C. He is a rich man
- D. He is careful.

34. As debutants in that tournament, the Super Eagles were up against their first opponents by three goals to nil

- A. The Super Eagles were playing in the tournament for the first

time, but they won their match by three goals to nothing

B. Though the Super Eagles were rated as the weakest side in the tournament, they won their first match by three goals to nil

C. Even though the Super Eagles were playing without some of their regulars, they won their match by three goals to nil.

D. As the best attackers in the match, the Super Eagles easily defeated their opponents by three goals to nothing.

35. The woman was mournful as her husband was found dead drunk

A. She was sad because of her husband was absolutely drunk

B. She was apprehensive that her husband would drink again as soon he recovered from the drunken stupor

C. She was sad because her husband was drunk and always as helpless as a dead man

D. She was mourning because her husband drank and died

In each of question 36 to 50, choose the option opposite in meaning to the word or phrase in *italics*.

36. I am optimistic about the interview though it was a *mind-bending* exercise

A. An enervating

B. A debilitating

C. A difficult

D. An easy

37. The trader was amused by *the cut-throat* rush for the goods

A. Worrisome

B. Strange

C. Lacklustre

D. Mad

38. The teacher said that Ali's essay was full of many *redundant* details

A. Unexplained

- B. Strange
- C. Necessary
- D. Useful

39. His father surmounted the *myriad* of obstacles on his way

- A. Most
- B. Few
- C. All
- D. Many

40. Her *ingenuous* smile drew our attention

- A. Witty
- B. Naïve
- C. Clever
- D. Arrogant

41. Ndeni gave a *flawless* speech at the party

- A. A wonderful
- B. A careless
- C. An interesting
- D. An imperfect

42. Beneath Ado's *guff* exterior, he's really very kind-hearted

- A. Nice
- B. Harsh
- C. Rough
- D. Gentle

43. The captain says sports is being *debased* by commercial sponsorship

- A. Localized
- B. Perverted
- C. Elevated
- D. Overvalued

44. Governing a country is not always as *straightforward* as people sometimes imagine

- A. Complicated
- B. Troublesome
- C. Untoward
- D. Irksome

45. The crowd was very *receptive* to the speaker's suggestion

- A. Disobedient

- B. Repellent
- C. Alert
- D. Hostile

46. There was a general *acquiescence* on the new drug law

- A. Resistance
- B. Discrepancy
- C. Compromise
- D. Agreement

47. Aisha seems to feel *ambivalent* about her future

- A. Decisive
- B. Anxious
- C. Ambitious
- D. Inconsiderate

48. The report of the committee contained a *plethora* of details

- A. Shortage
- B. Simplicity
- C. Multitude
- D. Spectrum

49. The weather was still very *heavy and sultry*

- A. Wintry and shadowy
- B. Cold and friendly
- C. Cloudy and thundery
- D. Hot and uncomfortable

50. Ada gave her husband a look that made words *superfluous*

- A. Redundant
- B. Spurious
- C. Unnecessary
- D. Scanty

In each of questions 51 to 65, choose the option nearest in meaning to the word or phrase in italics

51. A political Impasse does not offer the best opportunity for *merrymaking*

- A. manifesto
- B. party
- C. gridlock
- D. rally

52. We were all *enthusiastic* as we awaited the result of the election

- A. bemused
- B. agitated
- C. elated
- D. nervous

53. The uniform makes the guards look *absurd*

- A. dirty
- B. smart
- C. sensible
- D. ridiculous

54. The law is often *tardy* in reacting to changing attitude

- A. quick
- B. slow
- C. exclusive
- D. generous

55. Isa and Ilu ate *sumptuous* meal on their brother's wedding day

- A. expensive
- B. foreign
- C. insipid
- D. cheap

56. Kaltume *crouched* over the paper on her desk

- A. wrote on
- B. stood on
- C. walked over
- D. bent over

57. The *panacea* for a country's economic mess lies in systematic planning and hardwork

- A. cure
- B. hope
- C. foresight
- D. trouble

58. Thousands of workers have been victims of *retrenchment* since the military came back to power

- A. Unemployment
- B. Trench mentality

C. Suffering

D. Increase in penury

59. The principal gave his speech *offhand* at the sports meeting

A. calmly

B. beautifully

C. unconcerned

D. unprepared

60. Jankoli was dressed in an old *assortment* of clothes

A. Avalanche

B. Homogeneity

C. Sameness

D. Melange

61. The girl's father was *astounded* to see her appear from the shrine

A. collected

B. Overwhelmed

C. embarrassed

D. Astonished

62. The director's remark was extremely *apposite* to the issue being discussed

A. Appropriate

B. Inconsequential

C. Emphatic

D. Adequate

63. Her reputation is without a *blemish*

A. Struggle

B. Problem

C. Fault

D. Blessing

64. Ugo is *eligible* for the post of secretary

A. Nominated

B. Invited

C. Qualified

D. Intelligent

65. This is an *abridged* version of No Longer at Ease

A. An outdated

- B. An enlarged
- C. An illustrated
- D. A shortened

**In each of question 66 to 85,
choose the option that best
completes the gap(s)**

66. Lemoti..... as a painter, but
also as a sculptor

- A. is a gifted only not
- B. is only not gifted
- C. is gifted not only
- D. is only gifted

67. He can recall the important
dates in the nation's history, it is
interesting to listen as he rattles
.....

- A. off
- B. over
- C. up
- D. out

68. The boy told his mother

- A. that was the girl he told her
about

- B. that was the girl I told you
about her
- C. that was the girl I told her
about
- D. that is the girl he told her
about

69. Last Monday his father asked
me

- A. if I had come some days before
- B. if I had come the day before
- C. did you come yesterday
- D. had I come yesterday

70. His wife was badly injured in
the fracas, but I think she will pull
.....

- A. up
- B. over
- C. through
- D. back

71. A wide range of options
made available to students in the
final year last year

- A. is

- B. were
- C. are
- D. was

72. One of the women who
in the premises been ordered
to quit

- A. sells/have
- B. sell/has
- C. sell/have
- D. sells/has

73. The new trade agreement
should facilitate.....

- A. more economic rapid growth
- B. economic more rapid growth
- C. rapid economic more growth
- D. more rapid economic growth

74. The principal said that he was
pleased..... my effort.

- A. on
- B. of
- C. with
- D. about

75. Paper is made..... Wood pulp

- A. on
- B. of
- C. from
- D. with

76. Long after everyone.....the
hall, obi still sat inside.

- A. left
- B. is leaving
- C. has left
- D. had left

77. They are the.....dresses

- A. babys'
- B. baby
- C. babies
- D. babies'

78. The politician was sent.....
Exile

- A. onto
- B. into
- C. on
- D. to

79. When we looked up, we.....
the plane some miles away

- A. site
- B. cited
- C. sited
- D. sighted

80. Vital..... is still spread.....word
of mouth in most villages in Africa

- A. information/from
- B. information/with
- C. information/by
- D. information/through

81. Western education is one of
the..... of colonial rule.

- A. legacies
- B. evidence
- C. remnants
- D. inheritance

82. The federal government
has..... child trafficking

- A. postulated
- B. projected

- C. prescribed
- D. proscribed

83. The man was happy that his
son confessed his guilt and so the
others were.....

- A. Implicated
- B. accused
- C. punished
- D. exonerated

84. Based on the facts before me,
I have no alternative..... to hold
you responsible

- A. only
- B. as
- C. than
- D. but

85. Many people would always
find reasons to.....the law

- A. arrogate
- B. debase
- C. circumvent
- D. circumspect

In each of questions 86 to 88, choose the option that has the same Vowel sound as the one represented by the letters underlined.

86. Coup

- A. whup
- B. hoot
- C. couple
- D. scout

87. Indict

- A. bright
- B. fish
- C. pick
- D. brick

88. Roared

- A. towered
- B. coast
- C. brought
- D. rod

In each of the questions 89 to 91, choose the option that has

the same consonant sound as the one represented by letter(s) underlined

89. Sheath

- A. bathe
- B. length
- C. months
- D. paths

90. High

- A. what
- B. honest
- C. who
- D. vehicle

91. Of course

- A. plough
- B. dough
- C. over
- D. orphan

In each of question 92 to 94, choose the option that rhymes with the given word.

92. Boys

- A. stays
- B. moist
- C. noise
- D. elbows

93. Shine

- A. clean
- B. fine
- C. machine
- D. lain

94. Seer

- A. snare
- B. spare
- C. spear
- D. square

In each of question 95 to 97, choose the most appropriate stress pattern from the options. The stressed syllables are written in capital letter(s)

95. Political

- A. poliTical
- B. PoLitical

C. POLitical

D. political

96. Satisfactory

- A. saTISfactory
- B. satisFACtory
- C. SATisfactory
- D. satisfactory

97. captivity

- A. captiVity
- B. CAPtivity
- C. capTivity
- D. CAPtiviTY

In each of question 98 to 100, the word in capital letters has the emphatic. Choose the option to which the given sentence relates

98. EMEKA finished his home work yesterday

- A. Was Emeka helped to do his homework?
- B. Did Emeka do his homework?

C. When did Emeka finish his homework?

D. Who finished his home work yesterday?

99. Taiwo SAILED to London

A. Did Taiwo fly to London?

B. Did Taiwo sail to Brazil?

C. Did Taiwo sail to London?

D. Where did Taiwo sail to?

100. My bag is made of LEATHER

A. Whose bag is made of leather

B. Is my bag made of polythene?

C. Is Abu's bag made of leather?

D. Is my bag made of leather?

ANSWERS

1. A 2. D 3. C 4. D 5. A 6. A 7. B
8. A 9. D 10. B 11. A 12. C 13. C
14. C 15. B 16. B 17. C 18. A
19. B 20. B 21. D 22. A 23. D
24. C 25. D

26. B 27. B 28. B 29. A 30. C
31. C 32. B 33. A 34. A 35. C

36. D 37. C 38. C 39. B 40. D
41. D 42. A 43. C 44. A 45. D
46. A 47. A 48. A 49. B 50. D

51. C 52. B 53. D 54. B 55. A
56. D 57. A 58. A 59. A 60. D
61. D 62. A 63. C 64. C 65. D
66. C 67. A 68. A 69. B 70. C
71. D 72. D 73. D 74. C 75. C

76. C 77. D 78. C 79. D 80. C
81. A 82. D 83. D 84. C 85. C
86. B 87. A 88. A 89. B 90. C
91. C 92. C 93. B 94. B 95. B
96. B 97. C 98. D 99. A 100. B